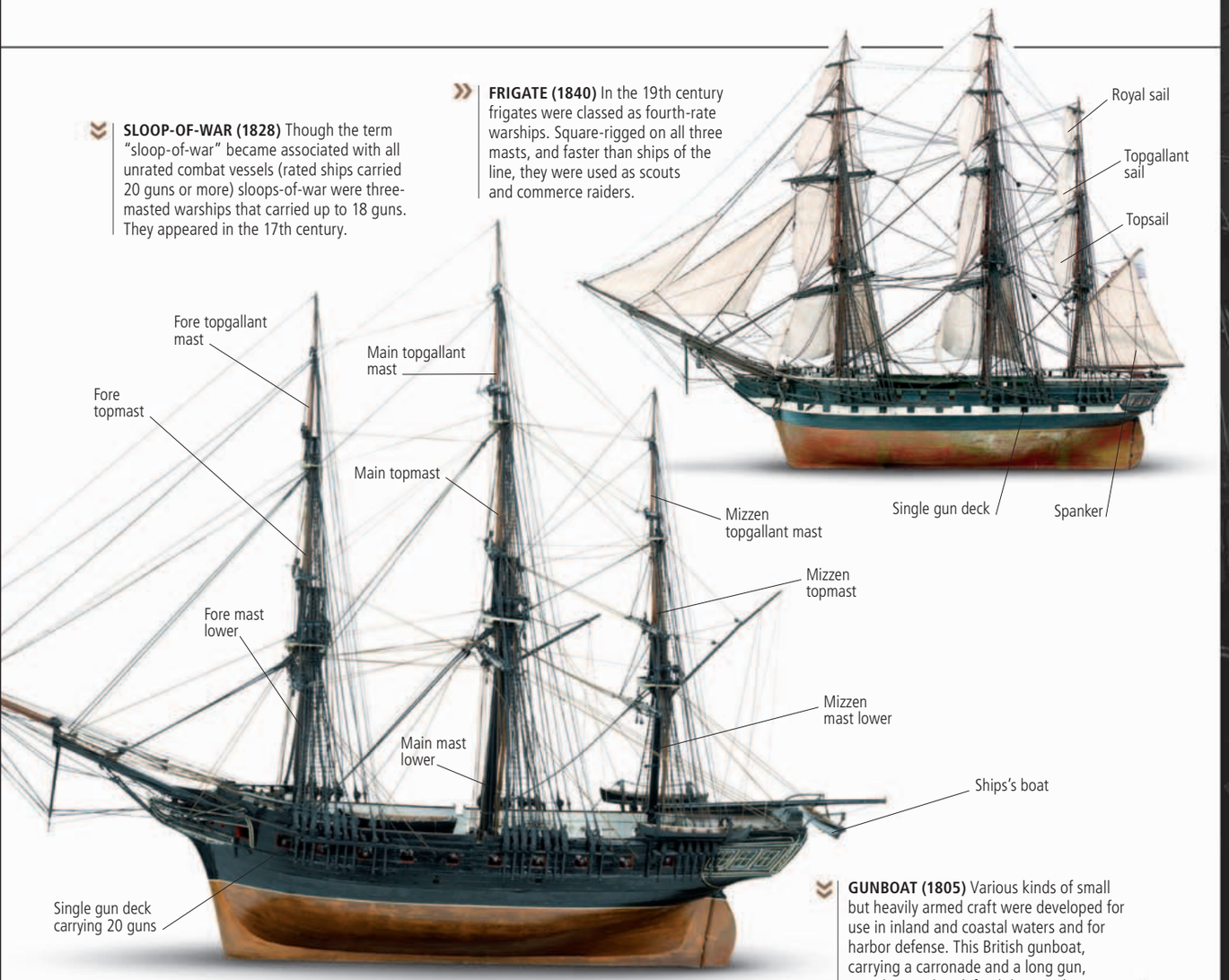
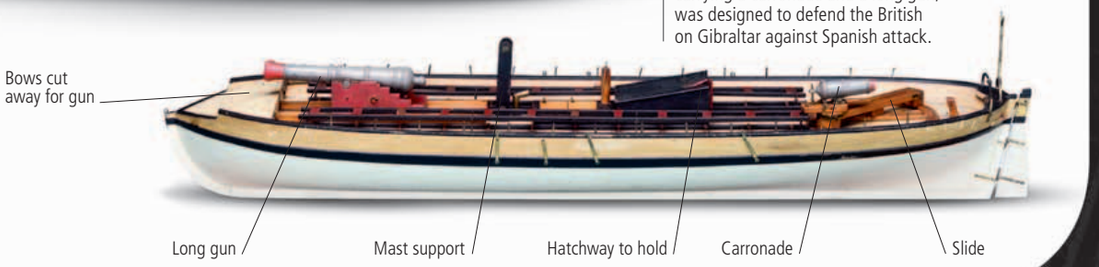
SLOOP-OF-WAR (1828) Though the term "sloop-of-war" became associated with all unrated combat vessels (rated ships carried 20 guns or more) sloops-of-war were three-masted warships that carried up to 18 guns. They appeared in the 17th century.

FRIGATE (1840) In the 19th century frigates were classed as fourth-rate warships. Square-rigged on all three masts, and faster than ships of the line, they were used as scouts and commerce raiders.



GUNBOAT (1805) Various kinds of small but heavily armed craft were developed for use in inland and coastal waters and for harbor defense. This British gunboat, carrying a carronade and a long gun, was designed to defend the British on Gibraltar against Spanish attack.



GLOSSARY

DROMON Byzantine warship powered by combination of oars and lateen sails.
E-BOAT High-speed torpedo boat used by Germany in World War II.
ELECTRONIC COUNTERMEASURES In modern warfare, any electronic devices designed to mislead the enemy's radar and other detection or targeting systems.
FIRESHIP Ship deliberately set on fire and propelled toward enemy ships as an incendiary weapon.
FLEET IN BEING A naval force that avoids battle by remaining in port, but remains a theoretical threat to the enemy.
FLINTLOCK Firing mechanism that used spark from steel striking a flint to ignite priming powder. Used for muskets from the 17th century and adopted on some cannon in the following century.
FORE Toward the front of a ship.
FORE-AND-AFT RIG Rig of a sailing ship where the sails are mounted along the line of a ship from stern to bow rather than across it as in a square rig.
FORECASTLE Originally the raised structure at the front of a medieval ship that served as a fighting platform for archers, marines, etc. Now applied to the front part of a ship's upper deck.
FORETOP Platform for lookouts, marines, situated high on the foremast of a ship.
FRIGATE Originally a sailing ship developed in the 17th century that was faster than a ship of the line and had just one gun deck. Used for patrol and escort duties.
FUSTA Fast, light medieval galley.
GALLEASS Large war galley developed by Venetians in 16th century for carrying heavy artillery.
GALLEON The principal European warship of the 16th and 17th centuries. Longer and narrower than the earlier carrack.
GALLIOT Small galley.
GRAPESHOT Small metal balls packed in a sack, used as anti-personnel ammunition in cannons.
GRAPNEL A metal device with several hooks thrown on the end of a rope for grasping hold of another vessel. Also, a small, multi-hooked anchor.

